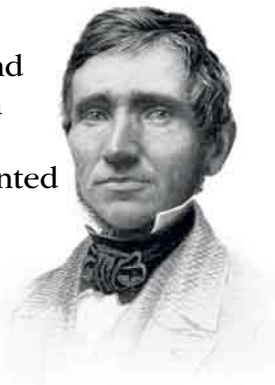


Selling soles

Sports shoes were up and running by the mid-19th century, after American **Charles Goodyear** invented vulcanized rubber.

Billed as a flexible alternative to leather, the rubber-soled **SPORTS SHOE** was

adopted by the US Rubber Company in 1892, which established the Keds business in 1917 to make and market the shoes.



Sports shoes

New shoes for athletes and sports enthusiasts **FIND THEIR FEET** in the mass market

In the US, 350 million pairs are sold a year.

High tops protect the ankle.

Groundbreaking design

Soon, many companies were producing shoes that combined comfort and style.

Lightweight **canvas uppers** allowed air to circulate, while laces were loosened or tightened as required.

The shoes were nicknamed "**SNEAKERS**" because their vulcanized rubber soles let the wearer sneak around without being heard.

How it changed the world

Rubber-soled shoes allowed athletes to go farther and faster, and have become the first-choice footwear for millions.

the world

Laces are fed through metal eyelets (holes).

Thick rubber soles cushion the foot.

Staying ahead of the game

In the 1930s, shoe companies began tailoring their products to **sports**. Studs were screwed into soccer shoes for better support, clips were added to cycling shoes to prevent slippage, and spikes on sprinting shoes improved grip.

Today's **high-tech sneakers** include automatically adjusting cushioning systems that adapt to the individual wearer and specific surface to ensure peak performance.

